JASON BENJAMIN

AI Product Engineer — Full-stack · LLM applications · EdTech

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PROFILE

AI product engineer: turns problems Korean teachers and parents describe into AI products, from the first interview to the App Store. 10+ years in Korean English academies and six AI products built solo; Chekki AI is live on the App Store and Google Play, and Chekki Schools is in final testing. At VODABI, builds the frontend, backend and database of VODATalk, a voice-AI sales training platform going into use with two enterprise clients. Works daily in English and Korean.

EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Engineer · VODABI

Jul 2026 – Present

Voice-AI sales training and testing platform · In production

– **Voice Pipeline:** Moved live voice roleplay to a direct browser-to-OpenAI WebRTC connection (Realtime API, ephemeral tokens), taking the server out of the audio path.

– **Platform Revamp:** Improved and revamped the existing voice-testing platform, added a coaching layer, and shipped it to production in about 3 weeks.

– **Two-Step LLM Grading:** Split rubric grading into a scoring call and a feedback call written from the fixed scores, so feedback never contradicts the number.

– **Admin Console:** Built a backoffice where non-engineers create personas, scenarios and scoring tiers without code.

– **Security:** Ran three security audits on a system handling candidate PII: field-level encryption, token hardening, role checks, and a regression test across every controller.

– **Performance:** Cut the login page's mobile LCP from 14.3s to 3.9s and its weight by 77% (Lighthouse lab runs) by re-encoding a 2 MB background image; wrote a read-only API latency benchmark that found a list response that was 85% unused data, and cut it by 84%.

– **Deployment:** Set up an arm64 staging environment beside amd64 production, with one CI/CD pipeline building for both.

– **Frontend:** Rebuilt the frontend from a designer's Figma spec: live roleplay, gamified reports, staff training screens and a manager dashboard.

– **Traction:** Going into use with two enterprise clients for employee sales-skills testing; opened candidate links to phones and hardened calls against mic loss and concurrent starts ahead of the pilot.

Founder & Product Engineer · Chekki EdTech Solutions

Jan 2024 – Present

AI homework grading and parent reports for Korean English academies · Web · iOS · Android

– **Core Loop:** Designed a parent → teacher → director loop: parents scan homework and get bilingual grading in seconds, and mistakes roll up to a class view for the teacher.

– **Grounded Grading:** Built Gemini vision grading that checks every answer against the teacher's uploaded answer key instead of the model's own guess.

– **Chekki Schools (in final testing):** Foreign teachers record one voice note per class; it becomes a Korean parent report that a Korean teacher reviews before families receive it. Two-school pilot planned.

– **AI Output Evaluation:** Rewrote the report prompts after native Korean readers said the drafts sounded machine-written.

– **Security:** Ran three security audits, closed 7+ authorization gaps, and added Firestore rules tests to CI.

– **Product Decisions:** Kept a 24-entry decision log, including cutting five scope-creep features and a feed filled with placeholder posts.

– **Refactor & CI:** Split a 4,678-line page into role-scoped modules with no regressions, and added the first CI pipeline and test suite.

– **Web Performance:** Raised mobile Lighthouse performance from 71 to 95 and cut LCP by 57% (5.95s → 2.53s) by prerendering the React landing pages at build time, inlining critical CSS, code-splitting and deferring third-party scripts.

– **Cross-Platform:** Shipped web, iOS and Android from one codebase (React 19 + Capacitor) with Korean/English parity, subscriptions, and Apple, Google and Kakao sign-in.

Curriculum Lead & Senior Educator · Blend ENG Academy · Seoul *Feb 2023 – Feb 2026*

Private English academy · Kindergarten and elementary

– **Commercial Curriculum Series:** Designed a 20-volume English curriculum series with AI tools and Canva, used by ~200 students from age 5 through elementary and sold commercially.

– **Diagnostic Benchmark System:** Built a school-wide diagnostic benchmark to find learning gaps and target intervention; the basis for Chekki's Benchmark AI.

– **Bilingual Operations:** Ran bilingual parent communication, progress reports and homeroom operations.

Homeroom Educator · YBM PSA Seocho · Seoul *Feb 2019 – Feb 2023*

Full-immersion EFL instruction · One of Seoul's largest English kindergartens

– **Immersive Instruction:** Four years of full-immersion EFL teaching at one of Seoul's largest English kindergartens.

English Teacher · English academies (hagwons) · Korea *2015 – 2019*

EFL instruction · Kindergarten and elementary

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & Voice Systems: OpenAI Realtime API (WebRTC, ephemeral tokens), GPT-4o, Gemini 2.5 Flash/Pro (multimodal/vision), LLM Judge Architecture, Deterministic AI Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, Structured JSON Outputs (constrained responseSchema), Hallucination Mitigation, Retrieval-grounded generation

Engineering & Infra: React 19, TypeScript, Vite, NestJS 11, Node.js 24, Prisma 7, MariaDB, Firebase/Firestore, Firestore Security Rules, Capacitor (iOS/Android), RevenueCat, Docker/Compose, Caddy, AWS EC2, Upstash Redis, GitHub Actions, Vitest, Sentry, Vercel Serverless

Product & AI Management: PRD Authorship, 0-to-1 Product Development, Customer Discovery, User Research, Documented Decision-Making, Prompt Experimentation, A/B Testing, Go-to-Market, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, B2B SaaS, Enterprise AI SaaS, RBAC, Agile, OKRs, Retention & Churn Analysis, Bilingual Product Design (EN/KR)

Other Tools: Make.com, Airtable

EDUCATION

Master of Education (M.Ed.) — Educational Management *2022*

University of Essex

Bachelor of Commercial Law (LL.B.) *2013*

University of the Western Cape